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ture in the country has failed to keep pace with the auto industry's accelerated shift to EVs or the government's ambition to push clean energy.

This is when the EV population in India has touched 5.7 million, according to estimates from the Union transport ministry. At 3.2-3.5 million units, two-wheelers account for over half the total, followed by three-wheelers at 1.8-2 million units. Four-wheelers, though a relatively smaller segment at 250,000-300,000, are gaining ground rapidly. The remainder includes buses and commercial vehicles.

By comparison, India has only 26,367 public EV charging stations, 10,019 of which were added only in the past fiscal year. That's roughly one public charging station per 216 EVs. Globally, countries operate at far tighter EV-to-charger ratios. The Netherlands, for instance, has a public charger for every 2-7 EVs; China's top cities average one for every 3-6 EVs. Even California, which boasts extensive home and workplace charging, has a public charging station for 25-30 EVs.

EV-TO-CHARGER RATIOS: A COMPARISON

China	Netherlands	California, USA	India
one station per 3 to 6 EVs	*one station per 2 to 7 EVs*	*one station per **25** to **30** EVs*	*one station per **216** EVs*

life. The two turned to an online app to find out where they might find the next charger. One was located 20 km away, but when they reached it, they discovered it was newly installed and not yet connected to the grid. Another 25 km away, they found a third charger. Except that a non-EV here was parked wrongly, and its owner was nowhere to be found.

By this time, Zoravar and Rahul's range anxiety had hit its peak. They finally found a charger, at a Bharat Petroleum fuel station some 30 km short of Chennai, and plugged the car in, killing time at a small tea stall for the half an hour it would take for the car to charge. Unnerved by the experience, Rahul took a direct flight back to Delhi rather than do a return trip to Bengaluru.

Even as Elon Musk launched the Tesla Model Y in Mumbai in July and green-plated EVs become a common sight on Indian roads, the charging infrastruc-

The Government's Push

India's boom in EV sales has been fuelled by a mix of central and state incentives, most notably the FAME-II (Faster Adoption and Manufacturing of Hybrid and Electric Vehicles) scheme, which offers subsidies on EVs and support for charging infrastructure. The Goods and Services Tax (GST) on EVs and charging equipment has also been slashed to 5 per cent. Battery-operated vehicles sport green licence plates, exempting them from certain permit requirements. States have added measures like road tax waivers and registration fee exemptions.

Alongside, the PM E-DRIVE (PM Electric Drive Revolution in Innovative Vehicle Enhancement) initiative is aimed at expanding charging facilities at a commensurate rate. Of the Rs 10,900 crore fund, Rs 2,000 crore is earmarked for augmenting public charging stations in urban as well as semi-urban and rural areas.

Guidelines for setting up infrastructure and leasing public land are also being established. Last year, the Union power ministry issued a set of rules mandating that new charging stations service both old and new EVs, a response to widespread complaints that older stations were incompatible with the latest EV models. Distribution companies will be required to supply power connections up to 150 kW. Public land is being offered on a revenue-sharing model at a floor price of Re 1 per kWh for 10 years.

These measures have done little to alleviate the concerns of the Indian consumer. According to the Deloitte 2025 Global Automotive Consumer Study, a substantial 70 per cent of Indian EV buyers want to charge primarily at home, but just 44 per cent own a charger. Another 41 per